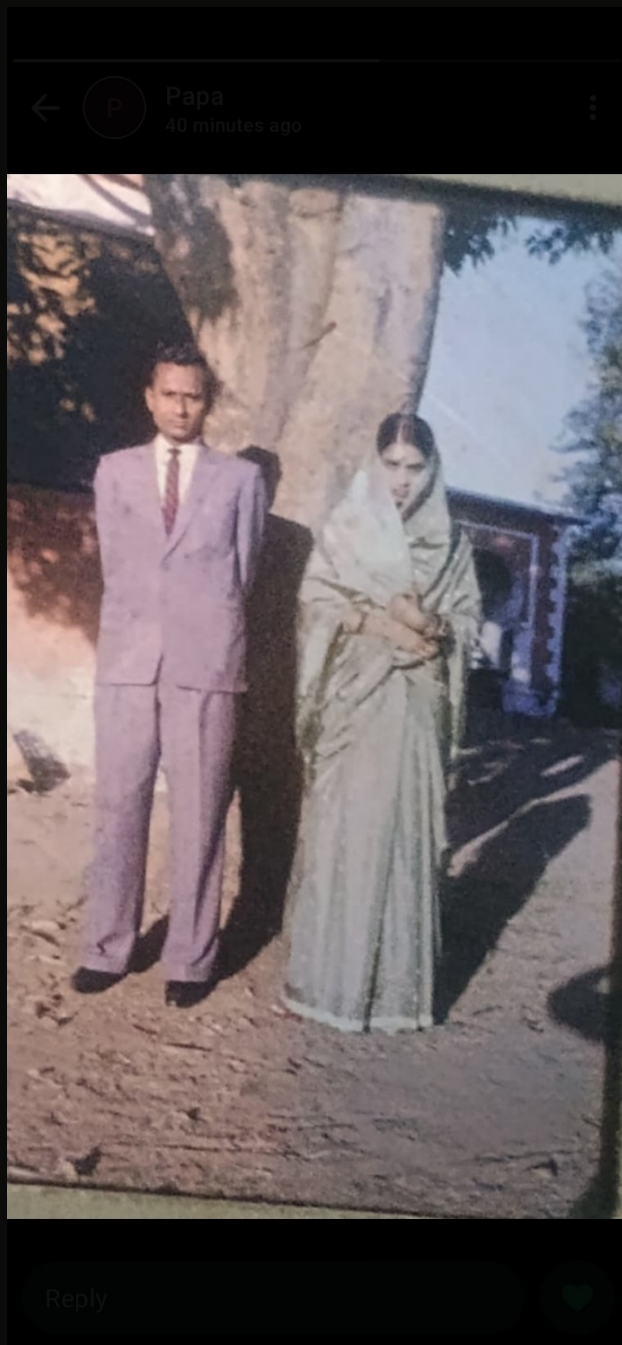


MEMORY MACHINE

A physical AI experience for preserving the feeling behind a memory.



THE ORIGIN

I have a photograph of my grandfather—someone I never had the chance to know.

Memory Machine begins with a personal absence and asks whether technology can help us preserve the stories, atmosphere and context surrounding a memory without pretending to recreate facts that are gone.

From storing memories to experiencing them.

Today, our memories are scattered across camera rolls, chat histories, cloud drives and old photographs. These systems preserve data, but they rarely preserve the atmosphere, context and human meaning attached to it.

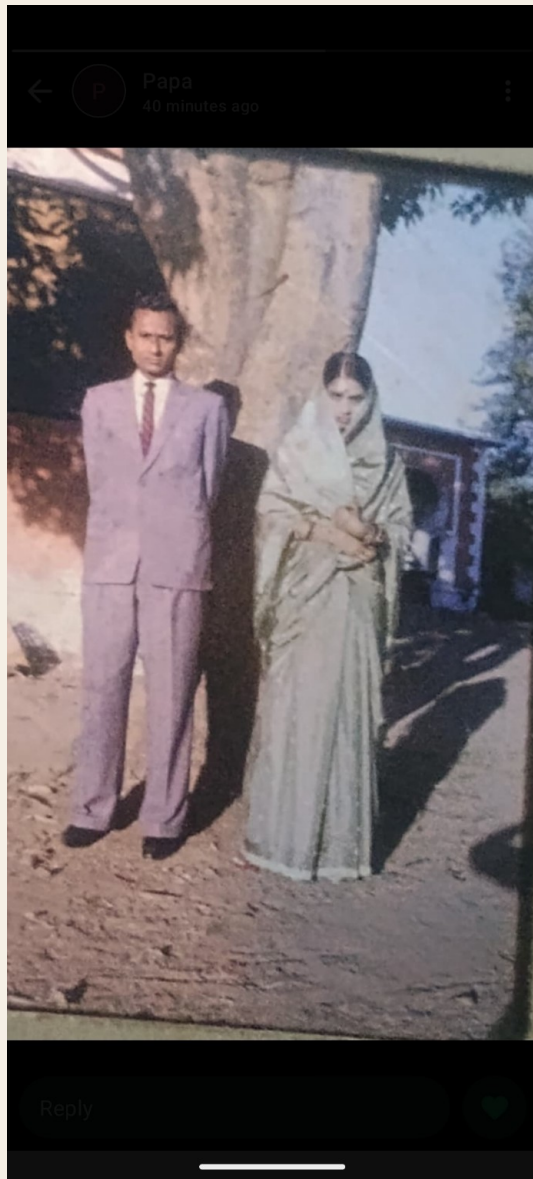
Memory Machine imagines a different relationship with technology: a physical object people approach with something personal, tell its story, and leave with a new artifact they can revisit.

THE NORTH STAR

“What if a machine could help us hold on to what matters—not by replacing a memory, but by giving it a second life?”

HUMAN FIRST	Every output begins with a real person's source material: a photograph, voice, note or story.
HONEST AI	The system distinguishes known context from creative interpretation. It does not claim to recover thoughts, facts or personalities from an image.
TANGIBLE EXPERIENCE	The project is intentionally physical: a person interacts with an object, not just another screen.

One photograph. Decades of unanswered questions.



THE PHOTOGRAPH

My grandfather and grandmother in India in the 1970s.

My grandfather passed away in the mid-1970s, when my father was around seven or eight years old. I was born much later and never met him.

My family remembers him as a successful lawyer who travelled abroad for legal study and case-related work. The photograph suggests a life, but it cannot tell me the whole story.

That gap—between what survives and what is lost—is the emotional starting point for Memory Machine.

THE PROJECT'S PERSONAL PROMISE

I cannot bring my grandfather back. I cannot ask him questions. But I can build a way to gather what remains—photographs, family stories, context, sounds and words—and transform those fragments into something I can return to.

A memory enters. An artifact leaves.

01	GIVE	Photo, voice note, handwriting or story.
02	UNDERSTAND	Organize people, places, time, context and source material.
03	INTERPRET	Generate a visual atmosphere, soundscape and written reflection.
04	PRESERVE	Bundle the source and outputs into a personal QR/NFC-linked archive.

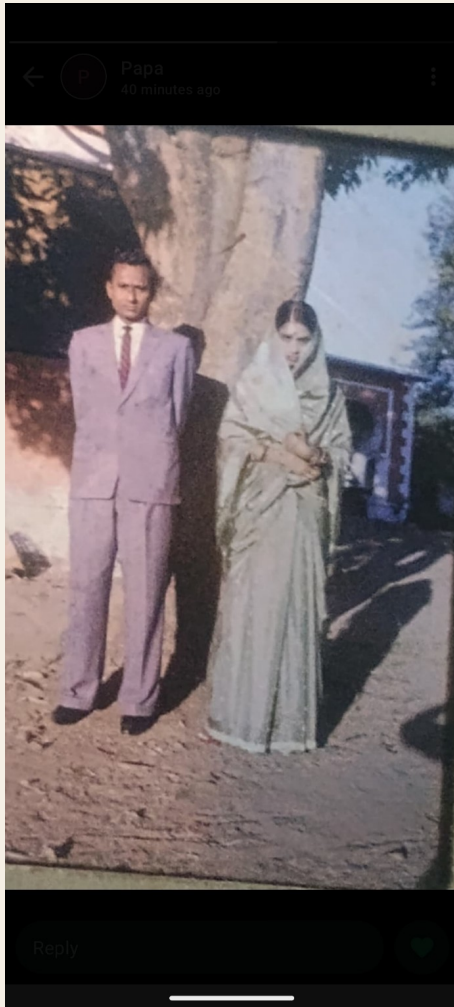
THE RESULT

A complete memory artifact: original source + visual interpretation + soundscape + written reflection + contextual archive.

The original memory remains the anchor. Generative outputs are explicitly presented as interpretations, so the project can be emotionally ambitious without confusing imagination with historical fact.

The first memory I would put through the machine.

SOURCE



1970s family photograph + family-provided context.

POSSIBLE MEMORY ARTIFACT

VISUAL

A period-inspired scene that evokes the setting and journey described by the family—clearly labeled as an artistic interpretation.

SOUND

A restrained soundscape built around the era and context: room tone, distant streets, travel ambience and subtle musical texture.

WORDS

A short reflection that places the known family story beside the questions the photograph leaves unanswered.

ARCHIVE

Original photograph, source story and generated outputs stored together and retrievable through QR/NFC.

DEMO LINE

“This is what remains of someone I never met. Memory Machine asks what we can responsibly build around what remains.”

The value is not the technology. It is the relationship it creates.

EMOTIONAL VALUE	Gives families a new way to revisit stories that might otherwise disappear between generations.
CREATIVE VALUE	Turns personal source material into original visual, audio and written art rather than another generic AI output.
CULTURAL VALUE	Can preserve oral histories, local stories, family traditions and everyday histories that rarely enter formal archives.
ACCESSIBILITY	A physical, guided experience can make digital storytelling more approachable for people who do not live inside creative software.
EDUCATIONAL VALUE	Creates a tangible way to explore history, memory, uncertainty and the limits of machine interpretation.
OWNERSHIP	The original source and resulting creative work remain tied to the person and their story rather than disappearing into a generic content feed.

From one family photograph to a living memory platform.

The first prototype is intentionally small. The long-term vision is much larger: a system that helps people preserve personal histories across generations while keeping the human source at the center.

V1	THE MEMORY OBJECT	A beautiful physical prototype that accepts a photo/story and creates one complete artifact.
V2	FAMILY MEMORY ARCHIVE	Multiple family members contribute voices, stories, photographs and corrections around the same memory.
V3	PLACE & COMMUNITY	Local histories, oral traditions and disappearing stories become participatory memory collections.
V4	LIVING MEMORY ATLAS	A network of linked memories—people, places, objects and stories—forming a human-centered archive of everyday life.

LONG-TERM AIM

To make personal memory feel less like a file you store and more like a place you can return to.

Build one beautiful thing all the way through.

The grant would fund a focused prototype rather than an overbuilt product. The objective is to prove the experience end-to-end and learn from real people using it.

Physical enclosure & fabrication	\$450
Compute / embedded hardware	\$350
Audio, microphone & speakers	\$180
Camera / input hardware	\$120
AI & generative software costs	\$300
Display / NFC / QR / electronics	\$200
Documentation & presentation	\$200
Contingency / iteration	\$200

THE FIRST MILESTONE

A working Memory Machine prototype + one fully documented family memory journey + a short cinematic demo that communicates the idea without technical explanation.

FINAL NOTE

“I don't want to build another AI tool. I want to build something people remember.”

KAVYA NARAYAN SHARMA / CREATOR